

Arashk Afshar

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Microeconomic Theory, Public Economics, Political Economy

EDUCATION

Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ

Ph.D., Economics (expected May 2027)

M.A., Economics, 2023

Advisor and Dissertation Committee Chair: Oriol Carbonell-Nicolau

University of Washington Tacoma, Tacoma, WA

B.A., Business Administration (Finance), *Summa Cum Laude*, 2019

B.S., Mathematics, *Magna Cum Laude*, 2019

Green River College, Auburn, WA

A.A., Business, *Highest Honors*, 2016

JOB MARKET PAPER

Progressive Taxation and Dynamic Wealth Inequality under Luxury Saving

When the rich save a rising share of their wealth, a tax can compress the distribution at every date and still leave the sequence of distributions pulling apart. I show that the classical characterizations hold within a period but have no counterpart across periods, and that what governs the trajectory is whether a second levy on accumulated wealth takes back what accumulation has spread apart, a contest the static criterion does not speak to. An income tax loses it at every rate; a wealth tax need not win it.

WORKING PAPERS

The Myth of the Informed Voter

Even fully informed voters can be decided by which issues a campaign makes salient rather than by what they know: money shapes elections through attention, not information. A binding spending cap forces competition across many issues at once, though whether it seats the broadly representative candidate depends on the structure of the electorate.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Saving as Instrument and Status: Progressive Taxation in a Dynamic Economy

A dynamic extension with forward-looking agents, which asks whether the non-convergence result depends on myopia. It does not. Anticipating the returns to accumulation, the wealthy save more aggressively still, and containing the divergence requires marginal-rate progressivity, a stricter standard than average-rate.

PRESENTATIONS

- *Progressive Taxation and Dynamic Wealth Inequality under Luxury Saving*. Microeconomic Theory Workshop, Rutgers University, October 2026.
- *The Myth of the Informed Voter*. Microeconomic Theory Workshop, Rutgers University, 2024.

TEACHING

Fourteen sections as instructor of record at Rutgers across five courses, twelve in upper-level economics (300/400), with regular-semester enrollments up to sixty-three. All are taught or in progress but Spring 2027. Designed each of the three electives around a semester-long policy analysis paper, presented at both proposal and final stages.

- **Econ 440: Economics of Income Inequality and Discrimination.** Spring 2025, Spring 2026, Spring 2027 (scheduled). Designed the course and syllabus from a dormant catalog listing.
- **Econ 438: Education Economics.** Fall 2026 (in progress). Designed the syllabus.
- **Econ 402: Labor Economics.** Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026. Designed the syllabus.
- **Econ 320: Intermediate Microeconomic Analysis.** Summer 2023 (2 sections), Fall 2025 (2 sections), Spring 2026. Taught from a fully calculus-based treatment.
- **College Writing 101,** Department of English. Fall 2023 (2 sections).

Teaching Service: **Panelist and Breakout Facilitator**, New Teaching Assistant Orientation, Institute for Teaching, Innovation, and Inclusive Pedagogy (TIIP), Rutgers University, August 2025. Shared teaching experience and led a breakout session for more than 100 incoming teaching assistants.

Courses Prepared to Teach: Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics; Intermediate Microeconomic Theory; Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory; Money, Banking, and the Financial System; Mathematics for Economists; Statistics and Econometrics

Teaching Fields: Public Economics and Taxation; Microeconomic Theory and Game Theory; Industrial Organization; Labor Economics; Economics of Education

TEACHING AWARD

Sidney I. Simon Award, 2024. For outstanding teaching by a graduate student, Department of Economics, Rutgers University.

OTHER ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant, Rutgers University, 2021–2024
- Research Assistant, University of Washington Tacoma, 2018–2019

HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- Nominated, President’s Medal, University of Washington Tacoma, 2019
- Interdisciplinary Award, for outstanding treatment of mathematics within other areas of study, University of Washington Tacoma, 2019
- *Pi Mu Epsilon* (mathematics, 2017) and *Beta Gamma Sigma* (business, 2016) honor societies
- Multiple merit scholarships, University of Washington Tacoma and Green River College

SOFTWARE AND LANGUAGES

Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, $\text{\LaTeX}$ · English (fluent); Farsi (native)

REFERENCES

Oriol Carbonell-Nicolau (Advisor and Committee Chair)

Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · carbonell-nicolau@rutgers.edu

Richard P. McLean (Committee member)

Distinguished Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · rpmclean@economics.rutgers.edu

Andrew Mackenzie (Committee member)

Assistant Professor of Economics, Rutgers University · andrew.k.mackenzie@rutgers.edu